

PANTRY RELAY

Make the food already here go further.

Surplus coordination for a trusted pantry network

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Hack Away Hunger 2026

Coordination at network scale

700

partners and programs across 55 Iowa counties

Food Bank of Iowa describes a network large enough to make coordination matter. The unanswered question is how often one pantry's approved surplus can fill another's next-service gap.

Source: Food Bank of Iowa, FY2025 Impact Report. No partnership implied.

A shortfall before tomorrow's service

Cedar Grove

Produce above its own protected reserve

Eastside

An upcoming service needs 120 lb of produce

A useful transfer needs more than a match.

The receiving pantry must agree. Transport must fit.
Someone must record the pounds actually accepted.

Illustrative scenario. All pantry names and operating data are fictitious.

An explainable transfer proposal



Central Iowa Demo ...
DEMO WORKSPACE

YOUR WORKSPACE

Overview

Relay planner

Inventory

Pantries & needs

Deliveries

Impact & reports

Your team



Small relays.
Stronger communities.

Good food. Better connected.

DC

Demo Coordinator
Network admin

→

Workspace / Relay planner

• People powered. Purpose driven. ↺ D

DEMO Your own sample workspace. All organizations and activity are fictitious. Safe to explore

TURN AVAILABLE INTO ARRIVING

Find the next good match.

Practical connections, explained. You make the final call.

PLAN FOR THE REAL WORLD

Relay constraints

Maximum distance (miles)

50

Approximate straight-line distance, not driving miles.

Vehicle capacity (lb)

500

Maximum load for each individual relay.

Temperature-controlled transport

☒ Vehicle can maintain the required cold or frozen conditions.

Refresh matches →

Every match checks

☒ Protected source reserves

☒ Receiving storage & total capacity

☒ Service and food use-by deadlines

☒ Donor restrictions

☒ Stock already committed

3 workable connections

Checked Sep 22, 10:39 AM

01

Harvest apples & carrots

Produce Ambient

120

lb to relay

FROM Cedar Grove Pantry

→ ≈ 8.5 mi

TO Eastside Community Pantry

Why this connection works

Ranked by earliest receiving service, then earliest use-by cutoff

Protects 180 lb at the source pantry

Fills 120 lb of an unreserved produce need

8.5 approximate straight-line miles; confirm the route before dispatch

Destination storage and capacity checked, including pending deliveries

Ambient transport is compatible

Service Sep 23, 10:39 AM

Reserve this relay →

02

Fresh milk

Dairy Chilled

60

lb to relay

FROM Prairie Bridge Pantry

→ ≈ 9.2 mi

TO Eastside Community Pantry

Review the food, quantities and constraints before reserving stock.

The receipt is the outcome

120 lb

dispatched

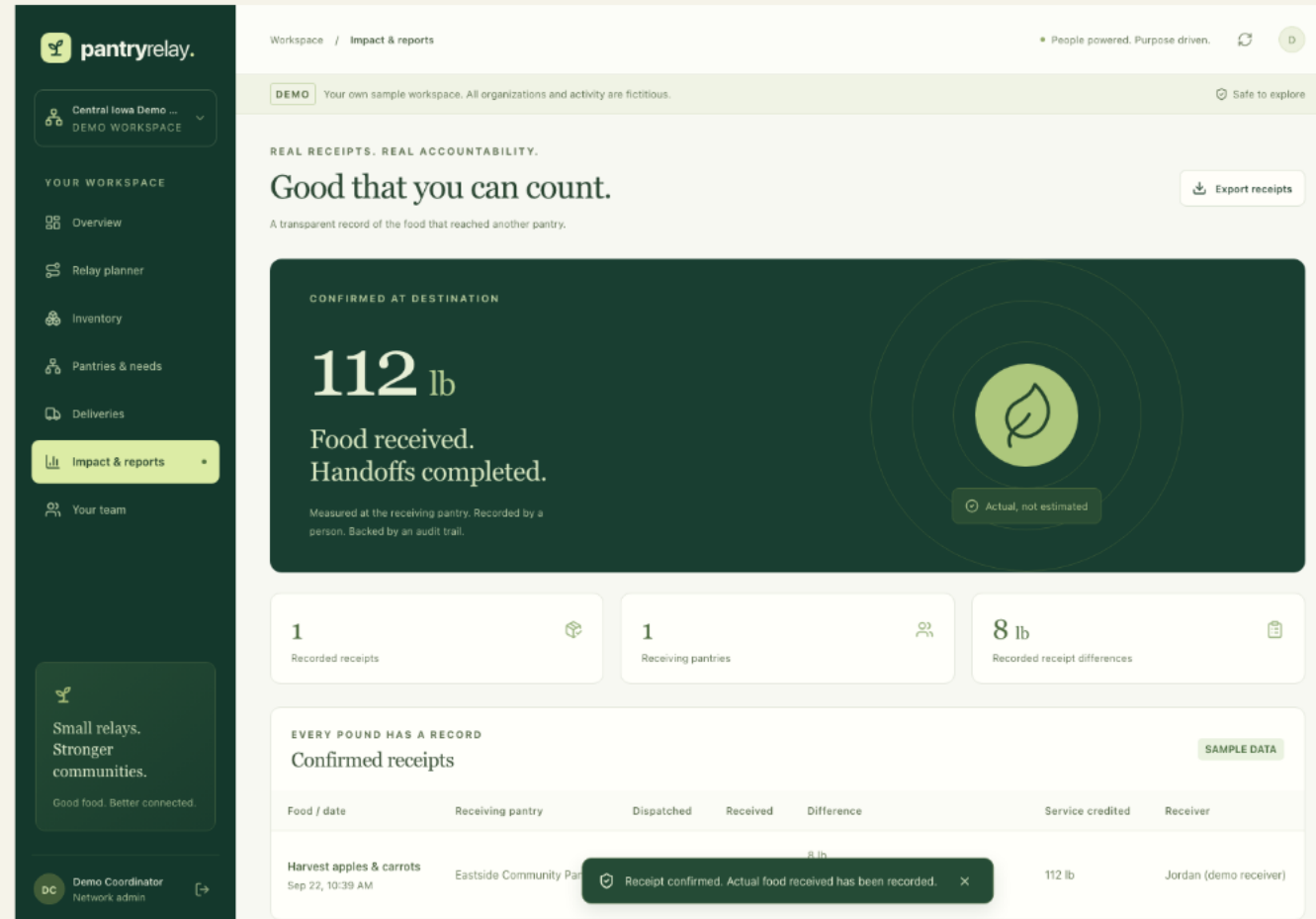
112 lb

accepted at the destination

8 lb damaged. The missing quantity reopens the need.

Illustrative partial receipt. Accepted weight is not a count of meals or people fed.

A complete handoff record



Authenticated actions, stock reservations, receipt differences and an exportable audit trail.

A proposed business model

\$149

per network / month

Up to 10 pantry sites. Free self-hosting.
A six-week supervised pilot comes first.

At a hypothetical \$25/hour staff cost, the price requires
about 6 hours saved per month to justify itself on time alone.

Six weeks to test the real value

01 **Baseline**

Observe existing transfers, entry effort and service gaps.

02 **Three pantries, one coordinator**

Run approved transfers with existing transport and clear safety ownership.

03 **A continuation decision**

Compare category gaps, staff time, transport effort and accepted weight.

THE NEXT STEP

One network. A real operating test.

We're looking for a coordinator and three pantries to test whether the next service can be better supplied.

Pantry Relay / Shivam Gupta
github.com/shi1720/Hack-Away-Hunger